

Documenting Pain for Disability Claims

A claim-facing guide to building pain records that can survive WorkSafeBC, insurance, and benefits scrutiny.

Routing Note

- Need:** Claims systems ask for clean records from lives that are anything but clean. This guide is for building proof anyway.
- Tool:** Use it when disability, insurance, or injury review depends on records that can survive scrutiny.
- Rule:** Do not dramatize. Do not soften. State what pain stopped, delayed, or damaged in real life.

Start Before the File Demands It

Claims systems love records that already existed before scrutiny began. Start now. A dated trail built under ordinary pressure reads stronger than a perfect record built after the stakes become obvious.

Function Makes the Claim Legible

Adjusters and reviewers are not persuaded by raw intensity alone. They look for what pain stopped, delayed, reduced, or made unsafe. Task failure is evidence.

Consistency Beats Theater

Brief daily entries beat polished weekly essays. Do not backfill. Do not dramatize. Let the repetition do the heavy lifting.

Good Days Stay in the Record

A believable file includes variation. Better days do not weaken the claim. They prove you are documenting a pattern, not performing one.

Tie Everything to Work or Daily Survival

For WorkSafeBC, connect symptoms to duties, hours, lifting, posture, pace, or tolerance. For disability, connect them to self-care, mobility, concentration, and daily living.

Make the Record Coherent Across Systems

Your diary should line up with appointments, meds, treatment attempts, and the medical timeline. The goal is not to sound dramatic. The goal is to sound impossible to misread.

Disability Documentation Checklist

- ☐ Consistent daily pain diary (30+ days minimum)
- ☐ Functional impact documented for each day
- ☐ Medication log with response tracking
- ☐ Medical appointment dates and outcomes noted
- ☐ Good days AND bad days recorded
- ☐ Specific activities affected (not just pain ratings)
- ☐ Summary prepared for adjudicator review